Apr

MOUNTAINEER

SPRING 1998 Volume 6 Issue 6





IS MY FACE RED!!!!!

In the December newsletter there was an oversight regarding the 25th Anniversary party that was held in September. The article mentioned all the hard work that the committee members had done, but it failed to mention who the driving force behind the celebration was. That person whom I neglected to mention was EVA LEHMAN. It was a terrible oversight on my part and I wanted to take this opportunity to let Eva know how sorry I was about this. Everyone knew that Eva had worked extremely long and hard for this celebration to be the success that it was.

MaryAnn Slushansian

NEIGHBOR TO NEIGHBOR

by Lon Dring

We were looking for a camp site when we happened upon Coolfont in 1976 or so. Where the health spa is now, there was a small camp store and the camp grounds on the other side of the lake were filled with campers. We liked the generous spaces and the wooded sites and began coming back regularly. I even held a few retreats for my board of directors in that forest. They spread out in the camp grounds and we had our meetings on the porch of the Woodland House.

Treetop House was half the size it is now. The special attraction was a sauna downstairs and later a hot tub off the back. There were square dances in the barn every Friday night and Raul Capon introduced the chamber music groups periodic performances at the Manor House. The town of Berkeley Springs was less active and a whole lot less sophisticated. Even then you could, for an extra twenty-five cents, sit on the couch in the Star Theater. The projector used to break down during most every show in those days. You could even appear at and walk on to the Cacapon golf course without waiting!

I have a vivid memory of that first visit to Coolfont, and the picture formed in my mind is my lasting impression of our much-loved community. It had already grown dark—that forest darkness where no lights are—as we ventured forth from our camper-trailer, flashlights in hand. My memory is of darkness and crickets chirping, with a few fireflies here and there, as we groped our way toward a lighted glass door in the Treetop basement. Feeling very much in the woods and away from it all, we opened the door to find an animated crowd of people. There were children sitting on the floor and moving about in the rear. All of them were attending a man giving a lecture on classical Cambodian dance, while his wife, in costume, demonstrated the movements to the phonograph music. That's Coolfont for me: a warm lighted place in a dark, quiet forest, a friendly and relaxed sophistication welcoming children—and me!

Carson Johnson built our cottage in 1980. My wife, Jan, and an architect had made careful plans, and Carson followed them carefully when it suited him. We sealed the deal with a handshake. We named our mountain home Narnia after the magic adventureland of C.S. Lewis' chronicles which I'd been reading to my son David. Coolfont has been a place and people of rejuvenating peace for me and the family for about 22 years.



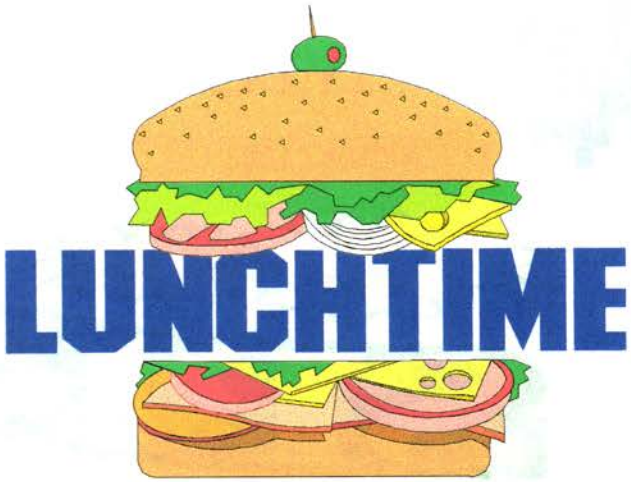
IT'S HUMMER TIME

Make sure you put your hummingbird feeders out the first or second week of April. That's when the little hummers come back to our area. You can buy the nectar already made up and just add water or you can make it yourself. One reason that hummers don't come to your feeder could be that the sugar solution has gone rancid. It must be changed and cleaned every three to four days. Just put a small amount out every few days until the birds come. BUT BE PATIENT. IT MAY TAKE SEVERAL WEEKS. It's worth it!!!!!!

The homemade solution should be 4 parts water to 1 part of granulated sugar. Don't make it any stronger. Add the sugar to water and boil it for two minutes to retard fermentation. Let it cool and fill your feeder. It isn't necessary to add red food coloring. You can keep your mixture in the refrigerator.

It is a fascinating sight to watch these little dive-bombers going from feeder to feeder and listening to their voices. We've spent the last couple of years watching these small birds fly, eat and fight with each other and it truly is a fascinating sight!

Also be on the look out for the return of the bluebirds. Last year we placed over twenty bluebird houses in the open meadow and they should be returning now. Elmer Broxson took the time a few weeks ago to do a little spring cleaning and cleaned the bluebird houses to get ready for the next renters.



INSPIRATIONS

Be on the lookout for a new shop coming to Berkeley Springs. It's called Inspirations and will be opening in mid-April. It is located at the corner of 522 south and 9 west (the old Antique House). Inspirations is going to carry a full line of baked goods, hearty breakfasts as well as gourmet coffee, espresso and cappuccino. If you are looking for a cake for any occasion, this is the place to try. They are also going to do catering. Look for a variety of specialty sandwiches and salads also to be available. Upstairs there are going to be a few rooms for rent.

Why not plan on stopping in and trying out Inspirations, the new bakery-cafe-bed and breakfast that is opening soon in Berkeley Springs. Make sure you tell your friends and neighbors on the mountainside if you go.

PRESIDENT'S CORNER

This article is being written by Gale Connor, Assistant to the President, and the Treasurer, Roland Siushansian.

It has been a long time coming but phase one of the water upgrade is now complete. Having said that, I would like to remind everyone that the "system" will continue to be tweaked, as we learn more about its capabilities. The new south reservoir has been in operation for several months and all the kinks have been worked out. The connections to the new main line have been made between the south and the north reservoirs. At the present time all of the mountainside homes are being fed from the south reservoir. The north reservoir and the "R" reservoir have been drained and cleaned. The plumbing in the north reservoir control room has been reworked, eliminating a lot of unnecessary piping. The control room building has been upgraded and painted.

It is not just a rumor. The south loop road will be repaved once the Spring rains have eased. The paving will include that section of road from Herbert Quick Drive around to Bobcat Drive. This work is currently scheduled for the end of April. Planning is being done to gravel the unpaved roads. The timing and the contractor have yet to be finalized. John Hobday, our Operations Manager, is handling this project.

The Board of Directors has approved a plan from the Pool Committee which includes the draining, patching, cleaning and painting of the pool. The Pool Committee has also recommended that a bath house be built in the pool area. Cost estimates will be obtained and submitted to the Board, for possible funding in the 1998-1999 budget.

While looking through my records for the first three quarters of this fiscal year, I am amazed at the amount of money that we have not been spending compared to last year. We have cut back on a lot of unecessay spending this year. I hope that if this trend continues, we will be signficantly under budget.

The figures for the water upgrade have been considerably lower than projected. This is all due to two people in particular.....Lee Weinberger and Gale Connor. Lee's engineering skills and hard work have saved us thousands of dollars.

Assessment bills will be coming out in June. I have been in touch with Paul Kagan regarding setting up separate accounts for water/sewer systems for this coming fiscal year. I understand this is the first stage necessary in proving to the PSC that we can exist with lower water rates.

BOARD MEMBER'S COLUMN

Jackson Bain

When Mary Ann Siushansian asked me to write a column for this newsletter, I quickly planned to share some observations from the four years I've spent serving on the CMA board, and to urge you to consider offering your own time to help make your community better. But I have reconsidered, and I now take my final opportunity to write this column to direct your attention to one Dr. Leon Weinberger.

All the haranguing and cajoling you've heard me do over the past four years to try to generate new volunteers for board or committee service is really best illustrated by the selfless dedication and constant, intelligent leadership that is provided by our CMA President, Lee Weinberger. Lee is more than a leader; he's a teacher, a mediator, a negotiator, an organizer, a planner and as the Georgia Tech students sing), he's a "hell of an engineer." He is, in short, exactly the right guy in the right job at the right time, and you and I and all of us are better off for his volunteer spirit than we will ever really know.

What makes someone like Lee give so selflessly of his precious time and energy? I know he loves this mountainside, and he and Greta created their beautiful home here to revel in the beauty and peace this place brings. But I also know Lee deeply and personally cares about people - you people. And that, among other engines, drives his dedication to helping make the place better. He is a perfectionist, and God knows we need that personality trait. He is also a sensitive listener, and we certainly could use more of those in the world.

So, here's the pitch. You should volunteer your time and your energy, even for one term, in some capacity for the betterment of your community here at Coolfont. And when you do, measure your eagerness and contribution against the volunteer accomplishments of Dr. Leon Weinberger. He is our valued neighbor and our good and loyal friend.

COMMITTEE UPDATES

DACC COMMITTEE
John Dowling

At the director of President Weinberger, the DACC for the past several months, has been working on the revision of the existing "CMA Regulations and Recommendations for Building at Coolfont" in order to make them more current. The Committee has determined that by streamlining and condensing our present regulations and recommendations, they will be more focused on those issues of most importance to the community and more readily implemented and enforced. To date, there have been several drafts and suggestions from committee members continue to come in. We had hoped to have a final draft submission for the CMA Board by now, but a number of unexpected events have caused a delay. We should have the final draft to the Board for action at the May meeting.

The Regulations and Recommendations are intended as an aide to lot owners, homeowners, prospective buyers and their builders. They are a result of collaborative efforts over the years within the CMA. These guidelines reflect an appreciation by the community of our concern for the quality of life on the mountainside; a commitment to preserve and enhance its natural beauty for all of our members.

Recently, it has come to our attention that there may be some confusion as to the procedure to follow prior to making any external changes or additions to houses or property on the mountainside. The committee would like to remind our members that they must inform the DACC of any proposed external alterations or additions to their houses or grounds. Any such changes must be requested on the CMA form provided with drawing and descriptions included. Approval requires three signatures of DACC members.

At our next meeting, the committee will be developing and drafting a policy on TV antennas, satellite dishes and such, for submission to the CMA Board for action.

There are currently three new houses under construction: S-5, S-2 and R-4. The owners of those not in conformance with DACC guidelines have been notified.

BYLAWS AND COVENANTS REVIEW
Herb Jasper

Last August, the President appointed a committee chaired by me, to make recommendations on revisions in the bylaws and covenants. The other committee members are Tim Black, Carl Bostrom, Elmer Broxson, Richard Kaufman, Jan Ormes and David Silver. Later, Lee asked the committee also to review the January 1989 Regulations Regarding the Use of Property.

Four members of the committee met in September and agreed upon a few changes in the bylaws. That group also reached consensus on all the issues involved in covenants amendments except for one. The use-of-property issues were to be considered later. I sent a report to all the committee members in late January asking if those not present agreed with the conclusions reached at the meeting. The report also contained preliminary suggestions regarding the use-of-property regulations.

As soon as I have received comments from a majority of the committee I will provide a report to the board. That should make it possible to schedule action or discussion on these important matters at the Annual Meeting in July.

COMMUNICATIONS/SOCIAL COMMITTEE
Rosemary Bigelow

Kitty Connor has been greeting new members of the mountainside and has given out seven welcome baskets.

We have received many suggestions to use our beautiful barn for more social occasions after our wonderful 25th Anniversary celebration last fall. The community is buying tables and chairs for the barn and will be holding events there in the future.

The second annual Newcomers' Brunch will be held Sunday, May 17th at 11am in the barn. This is the same weekend as the May Board meeting and will be the social function for that weekend instead of the Saturday evening pot luck. This is everyone's opportunity to meet and welcome new CMA neighbors. PLEASE LET US KNOW IF YOU ARE ATTENDING SO WE CAN PLAN THE FOOD!!! RSVP to Greta Weinberger, 304-258-3845 or Rosemary Bigelow, 30 258-5352.

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committee updates continued

Elmer Broxson will head the committee to plan a catered dinner at the barn following the annual CMA meeting, July 18, 1998 Watch for details on the cost and other activities. We would like to revive an old CMA tradition that new CMA members hold an open house during the weekend of the annual meeting. Call Rosemary Bigelow if you would like to participate and we will coordinate it with the other activities of that weekend.

We need volunteers for the calling tree—those folks who call and remind you of all the CMA events. Do consider helping out—it's a fun way to get to know some of your CMA neighbors. Call Rosemary if you would like to volunteer.

NOMINATING COMMITTEE
Ed Neill

At its meeting on March 14, the Board appointed the Nominating Committee for this year's election of Board members. The committee chair is Ed Neill. The other members of the committee are: Sandy Bain, Joan Bradfield, Dick Lehman and Nancy Thompson.

Now comes the hard part — identification of members willing to volunteer to serve on the Board. There are four Board positions to be filled this year. CMA members interested in serving on the Board personally, or in recommending other members for consideration are asked to please contact the chairman or any other member of the Nominating Committee as soon as possible. The annual meeting is simply not that far off and, as many of you may recall, the committee's list of nominees must be mailed to the membership well in advance of that meeting.

SAFETY COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS
Elmer Broxson

1. Check fire extinguishers and notify Elmer (202-333-8872) if any need to be recharged.
2. Inform all occupants of your house of these local emergency numbers: ambulance/fire 258-9911, WV State Police, 258-2101
3. Install whole-house water filters. Call John Hobday, 304-258-8141. Turn off water supply when house not in use.
4. Consider installing deer warning whistles on your cars; $6-10 in rural hardware stores.
5. Rake leaves at least 10 feet away from house to avoid rats, snakes, termites, rot and fires.

JANUARY BOARD MEETING SUMMARY

1. Water rates. As the water up-grade nears completion the Board will ask the PSC about conditions and procedures for lowering the water rates.
2. The DACC is preparing a new edition of the CMA

continued in next column

LOTS FOR SALE

LOT A-2	$33,00
LOT E-3	$34,500
LOT H-1	$47,500
LOT H-5	$33,000
LOT K-1	$42,500
LOT K-2	$38,000
both K-1 & K-2	$78,000
LOT K-12	$36,900
LOT K-14	$45,000
LOT Q-7	$47,000
LOT R-2	$65,000
LOT R-5	$66,000
LOT S-6	$68,950

HOUSES FOR SALE

Q-9 "Montebello" Three bedrooms, 2 1/2 baths, Jacuzzi. Most furnishing included. $194,800

C-5 "Pond House" Three bedrooms, two baths cottage. 1500 square feet. Includes all furnishings, $139,900.

K-3 "Grand Prix" Five bedrooms, 5 bathrooms, double Jacuzzi $175,000.

Q-4 "Morning Glory" Five bedrooms, 5 bathrooms, tiled steam room, DSS Satellite System, 2800 square feet. $275,000 unfurnished.

L-5 "Numbers" Four bedrooms, 3 bathrooms. Two-sided fireplace. 2,400 square feet. $215,000 unfurnished.

WHAT'S HAPPENING IN BERKELEY SPRINGS

In May, a new antique mall will be opening on Main Street (where the Tattoo Parlor used to be).

The fifth annual Uniquely West Virginia wine and food festival will be held April 17 and 18 at the Ice House.

Try the little flea market behind One Valley Bank for delicious baked goods, beautiful flowers (beginning in June) and other treasures. It is held from 10am to 1pm on Saturdays weather permitting.

minutes continued

Building Guidelines. Send any comments/suggestions to John Dowling

3. Sam Ashelman informed the Board that a 17-member hunting club has leased the 400+ acres to the north of the CMA for their exclusive year round hunting.
4. The Board continues to discuss plans to convert part of the barn into an office for CMA.
5. Members are asked to recommend to the Board any capital improvements for consideration at the annual meeting.
6. The Board has voted to support the local effort to arrange for a MARC commuter train stop in Hancock, MD.

BOARD MEETING DATES

Please put the following dates on your calendars.

APRIL 18 10:00
WHERE KAUFMAN'S
SOCIAL BARN/CONNOR'S
depending on weather

MAY 16 10:00
WHERE BOB DOWLING'S
SOCIAL BARN

JUNE 13 10:00
WHERE BALKAN'S
SOCIAL BARN

JULY 18 9:00
WHERE TREETOP

ANNUAL MEETING:
JULY 18 1:00
AT TREETOP

A CLOSER LOOK AT A NEW COMER

By Jim and Nancy Thompson

It's hard to think of ourselves as newcomers to Coolfont, since we are now veterans of six sometimes painful, always interesting CMA Annual meetings. But, the house on R-4 is finally under construction (much to Gale Connor's amazement). After all the daytrips to Coolfont required during construction, we are truly looking forward to spending the night in our own home and beginning to take advantage of all the wonderful things that attracted us to Coolfont.

We first came to Coolfont in the sultry summer of 1990 because Nancy wanted to go someplace "cool" for her birthday. What better place than Coolfont? Like most people, we were amazed at the variety of things to do both at Coolfont and in Berkeley Springs. We both love the mountains and had talked about getting a place with mountain views, so when Nancy had an office retreat at Coolfont in early 1992, we extended the stay into the weekend and talked to Sam about property. As it turned out, the deposit holder of R-4 was willing to release the property. With the breathtaking view and despite the steep building site and price, we couldn't say no. While contemplating that decision, we both understood that this meant drastic changes in our very independent lives - like a long term commitment to each other, marriage? maybe even living in the same state for the first time. Talk about a life-altering week-end!

So, we eventually got married (1993), moved to the same state and house (1995) and decided we couldn't handle kids in college in our seventies - so we rescued Pebbles (the cat) from the animal shelter (1997).

After our typical procrastination and stumbling through the architect and builder selection process, we started construction of Point of View last summer and hope to move in this spring. We are looking forward to escaping DC traffic on the weekends, golfing at Cacapon, Nancy's crafting, hosting family and friends, getting more involved with the CMA and Berkeley Springs community, giving Pebbles new places to explore and enjoying the view.